Designed to Wander

From Jaipur to Paris, designer Ritu Beri reveals the destinations that define her aesthetic and fuel her creativity



Which are your favourite design-forward Indian cities?
Jaipur, Goa and Delhi top my list. Jaipur inspires me with its craft, heritage, architecture and a beautiful blend of traditional and contemporary design. Goa is a creative, free-spirited mix of art, nature and culture. Delhi, of course, is home. It's timeless, eclectic and constantly pushing boundaries with its design language.

As the founder of multi-brand boutique Escape, you've spent a lot of time in Goa. Tell us some lesser-known spots that more people should discover.
If you love discovering old Portuguese homes and intimate cafés, spend some time in Vaddy, a tiny pocket of Assagao. Keri (Querim) Beach is another favourite—serene, unspoilt and mercifully free of too many shacks. And then there's the non-touristy Chorao Island, with its winding roads, heritage homes and the peaceful Dr Salim Ali Bird Sanctuary.

A winter destination you can't get enough of?
I am not particularly fond of winter, but if I had to choose a destination, it would be Paris. It feels magical that time of year—elegant, beautifully lit and endlessly inspiring. Walking its streets in winter, with the cafés, the art and the architecture, sparks something creative in me.

What kind of traveller are you?
I am an intuitive traveller, who loves spontaneity, beauty and comfort. I enjoy exploring new places but naturally gravitate toward experiences that feel authentic and not overly crowded. For me, travel is about inspiration and energy, not ticking off boxes.

Do you enjoy exploring food on your travels? Any unforgettable experiences?
I am a real foodie and love exploring different cuisines when I travel. Some of my favourite stops include Trattoria Cammillo in Florence, a family-style spot; L'Ami Jean in Paris, a Basque restaurant known for its incredible rice pudding and rustic plates; and Ichiran in Kyoto for simple, soulful ramen.

–with Geetika Sachdev